

End User Awareness Materials

Document Information

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Executive Summary

This guide gives every employee at [Organization Name] a plain-language introduction to data governance: what it is, why it matters, and what is expected of them day to day. It is designed for broad distribution as part of onboarding and ongoing awareness campaigns.

1. What Is Data Governance?

Data governance is how [Organization Name] makes sure its data is accurate, secure, well-organized, and used responsibly. It is not just an IT function — it is a shared responsibility across every team that creates, touches, or uses data.

In simple terms, data governance answers:

- Who owns this data?
- Can I trust it?
- Who is allowed to see or use it?
- How long do we need to keep it?
- What do I do if something looks wrong?

2. Why It Matters to You

- **Better decisions:** Trustworthy data means your reports, dashboards, and analysis are reliable.
- **Less rework:** Clean, well-governed data reduces the time spent fixing errors and reconciling numbers.
- **Regulatory protection:** Following data handling rules protects [Organization Name] and you from compliance violations and fines.

- **Customer trust:** Customers expect their data to be handled responsibly. Governance is how we keep that promise.
- **Career growth:** Data literacy and good data habits are increasingly valued skills in every role.

3. Your Role as a Data User

Everyone who interacts with company data has these baseline responsibilities:

- **Classify before you share:** Know whether the data you're working with is Public, Internal, Confidential, or Restricted (see the Data Classification Scheme), and handle it accordingly.
- **Use approved systems:** Store and process data only in approved, sanctioned systems — not personal drives, email, or unapproved tools.
- **Report issues:** If you spot incorrect, duplicate, or suspicious data, report it through the data issue process rather than fixing or ignoring it silently.
- **Protect personal data:** Treat customer and employee personal data with extra care. When in doubt, ask before sharing.
- **Keep only what's needed:** Follow retention schedules. Don't keep data "just in case" beyond what policy allows.
- **Ask your Data Steward:** Each business domain has a designated Data Steward who can answer questions about data in their area.

4. Everyday Dos and Don'ts

Do	Don't
Check the classification level before sharing a file externally	Email confidential or restricted data without encryption/approval
Use the data catalog to find approved, trusted data sources	Pull data from unofficial spreadsheets of unknown origin
Report data quality issues through the issue tracker	Silently "fix" data without informing the asset owner
Ask your manager or Data Steward when unsure about data handling	Assume any data is fine to share because "everyone has access"
Complete required data privacy and security training	Skip mandatory governance training modules

5. Who to Contact

Question Type	Contact
"Is this data accurate / where does it come from?"	Business Data Steward for the relevant domain
"Am I allowed to share this externally?"	Data Privacy Officer
"I found an error in a report or dataset"	Data Governance Office (issue tracker)

Question Type	Contact
"How long do I need to keep this record?"	Refer to the Data Retention Policy or Records Management team
"General governance questions"	[Data Governance Office email/Slack channel]

6. Frequently Used Terms

- **Data Steward:** A person accountable for the quality and proper use of data in a specific domain.
- **Data Classification:** A label (Public, Internal, Confidential, Restricted) describing how sensitive data is and how it must be handled.
- **Data Quality:** How accurate, complete, consistent, and timely data is.
- **Data Catalog:** A searchable inventory of [Organization Name]'s trusted data assets.
- **PII:** Personally Identifiable Information — data that can identify a specific person.

7. Getting Help and Learning More

- Complete the onboarding data governance training module within your first 30 days
- Bookmark the Data Governance intranet page for policies, FAQs, and contacts
- Reach out to your Business Data Steward with domain-specific questions
- Watch for governance updates in the company newsletter

Document Control:

- This is a template document requiring customization for specific organizational needs
- Sections in [brackets] require organization-specific information
- Recommended distribution: all-employee onboarding and annual refresher
- Regular updates required to maintain currency and effectiveness